

August 12, 2026

Medicare (Palmetto GBA, JM MAC)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Tobie Rempel (MRN MUSC6034627), Claim MUSC-20260110-FA13-1

Patient	Tobie Rempel (DOB 1934-04-09)
MRN	MUSC6034627
Member ID / Group	MED641920666 / GRP-61973
Claim number	MUSC-20260110-FA13-1
Date of service	2026-01-10
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	R69 — Illness, unspecified
Denied amount	\$505.49
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-06-18

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level redetermination request to Palmetto GBA (Jurisdiction M MAC) on behalf of patient Tobie Rempel (MRN: MUSC6034627, Member ID: MED641920666) regarding claim MUSC-20260110-FA13-1, covering a date of service of January 10, 2026, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center. The claim was denied on February 18, 2026, under CARC 16 / RARC N290, citing a missing or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. This appeal is submitted within the 120-day redetermination filing window and is accompanied by corrected billing documentation that resolves the identified deficiency.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Rempel is a 92-year-old established female patient with a documented history of stroke (I63.9), osteoporosis, hyperlipidemia, and obesity, all of which are active conditions under ongoing management. On January 10, 2026, she presented to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center for an outpatient evaluation and management visit (CPT 99214) rendered by James H. Ferrell, MD. The visit was billed at moderate complexity, consistent with the management of her multiple active chronic conditions. The claim was submitted on January 12, 2026, with a billed amount of \$505.49, against which Medicare's allowed amount is \$229.54. No payment has been issued to date.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is CARC 16 / RARC N290: "Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s)" — specifically, a "missing/incomplete/invalid rendering provider primary identifier." The payer's remark states: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid."

MUSC Health respectfully asserts that this denial reflects a correctable billing deficiency, not a question of medical necessity or coverage eligibility. The rendering provider, James H. Ferrell, MD, holds NPI 1992837465. This NPI is a valid, active Type 1 National Provider Identifier issued through the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES) and is the required primary identifier for Medicare claims under current CMS billing requirements. We are resubmitting this claim with the rendering provider NPI clearly and correctly populated in the appropriate claim field (Loop 2310B, NPI qualifier XX, for professional/institutional electronic claims). Supporting documentation confirming Dr. Ferrell's NPI is enclosed with this redetermination request.

Medicare regulations and CMS claims processing guidelines require that a claim containing a correctable data element error be given the opportunity for correction and reprocessing rather than outright denial without recourse. The service itself — an established-patient outpatient evaluation and management visit for a 92-year-old beneficiary with multiple active chronic conditions — is a covered benefit under Medicare Part B, and Ms. Rempel's coverage was active on the date of service. There is no indication of a coverage, eligibility, or medical necessity issue; the denial is purely administrative in nature.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Palmetto GBA reopen and reprocess claim MUSC-20260110-FA13-1 with the corrected rendering provider NPI for James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465) and issue payment at the applicable Medicare allowed amount of \$229.54 for CPT 99214, date of service January 10, 2026. Should additional documentation be required to complete adjudication, we ask that Palmetto GBA contact MUSC Health's Revenue Cycle department directly so that any outstanding items may be resolved promptly and without further delay to payment.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record